

Japan embraces robots ahead of 2020 Olympics
BBC, Technology, Spencer Kelly, 11/14/2016, 1min51s

1. The video was filmed ...

☒ Before the Olympics. ☐ During the Olympics. ☐ After the Olympics.

2. Who was the translator robot meant for?

tourists or visitors

3. What did the man order?

☒ A pet. ☐ A drink. ☐ A robot.

4. The translate robot represents a real technical advantage compared to a translation app.

☐ True ☒ False

Justify your choice in your own words or by quoting the audio document:

It may seem totally unnecessary to put a robot front end on what is in effect a simple smartphone translation app

5. Because there's not enough living space in Tokyo, people only own small pets.

☐ True ☒ False

Justify your choice in your own words or by quoting the audio document:

It is after all a city where the lack of living space means that pets can be rented by the hour.

6. The video was originally supposed to be filmed in another place.

☒ True ☐ False

Justify your choice in your own words or by quoting the audio document:

The bunny café was full

7. The Japanese are reluctant¹ to robots.

☒ True ☐ False

Justify your choice in your own words or by quoting the audio document:

The point is that this country has a real love of robots

8. Give the name of a humanoid robot mentioned by Fumiyuki Hashimoto.

Astroboy

1 Reluctant : réticent, peu enthousiaste.

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<https://www.bbc.com/news/av/technology-37910123>

One of the many projects hoping to be ready for the onslaught of visitors for the 2020 Tokyo Olympics is this translator bot to help tourists bridge the language gap.

- *Konnichiwa.*
- I'd like to order salt and pepper please.
- [*The robot translates the client's request.*]

It may seem totally unnecessary to put a robot front end on what is in effect a simple smartphone translation app, but Tokyo is a place with different priorities. It is after all a city where the lack of living space means that pets can be rented by the hour.

- Hey Salt and Pepper. [*Music*] Why are we demonstrating the robots in a hedgehog café? Because the bunny café upstairs was full. [*Music*] What do I do now?

Oh, and if you're wondering, I did feel a slight prick. Anyway. The point is that this country has a real love of robots. It's not just embracing the humanoid forms from the science fiction. It is embracing the brains, the artificial intelligence too.

- **I think that the Japanese consider artificial intelligence and robots as almost the same thing. In other words, robots contain AI and the robot is controlled by AI. As this notion is easy to grasp, the Japanese have favorable views on robots. In animated films such as Astro Boy and Gundam, robots are depicted as something that protect and support humans. Therefore, in my opinion, the Japanese feel familiar with the idea that we can do things with robots or AI.**